ECEM OZTURK

ART DIRECTOR

Toronto, ON · ecem.world · hello@ecem.world · LinkedIn

Multidisciplinary designer and art director with an MDes in Digital Futures and a BA in Product Design. I work across brand identity, art direction, and immersive digital experience — owning both the concept and the craft, then prototyping and shipping what I design. My practice spans visual identity systems, editorial and campaign direction, UI/UX, and 3D/VR, backed by the production discipline to carry creative work from first idea to launch.

CORE SKILLS

Creative Direction & Brand

- **Art Direction:** Concept development, visual storytelling & campaign direction.
- **Brand Identity:** Building visual identity systems & brand architecture.
- **Editorial & Copy:** Tone of voice, copywriting & narrative design.
- **Creative Strategy:** Positioning, moodboarding & a clear aesthetic point of view.

Visual & Experience Design

- **Typography & Layout:** Editorial layout, type systems & composition.
- **UI/UX & Systems:** Interface design & design systems in Figma.
- **3D & Immersive:** Modelling in Rhinoceros 3D; rendering & animation in Blender; VR in Unity.
- **Motion & Interaction:** Interaction logic & animated, interactive experiences.

Craft, Tools & Making

- **Design Tools:** Figma, Rhinoceros 3D, Blender, Unity & the Adobe ecosystem.
- **AI Creative Pipeline:** Expert prompting; Claude Code, Meshy & Firefly.
- **Creative Coding:** Prototyping interactive and web-based pieces.
- **Material Craft:** Machine knitting & hands-on textile experimentation.

Production & Delivery

- **End-to-End Delivery:** Taking creative projects from concept to launch.
- **Agile Production:** Sprint operations & roadmap prioritization (Asana).
- **Stakeholder Alignment:** Coordinating design, engineering & clients.
- **Global Launches:** Managing international product & brand rollouts.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance Designer & Graphic Designer | Independent

Remote · Toronto, ON · 2023 – Present

- Designed and built Shopify-integrated e-commerce websites and an Amazon brand presence — shaping visual identity, layout, and conversion-focused product pages.
- Created packaging design for home-appliance product lines, taking artwork from concept through to print-ready production.
- Produced e-commerce-ready product photography and a full suite of marketing collateral — catalogues, flyers, banners, and social media content — with a consistent brand look across channels.
- Designed sales pitch decks and presentation materials supporting client sales and market-expansion efforts.

Project Coordinator | Vretta Inc.

Toronto, ON, Canada · February 2026 – June 2026

- Coordinated delivery of a digital assessment tool for Canadian K–12 schools, running weekly stakeholder meetings and keeping design, product, and engineering teams aligned to schedule.
- Managed timelines, documentation, and cross-functional communication across the full project lifecycle.

Brand & Creative Lead, Market Expansion & Localization | Master Ev Gereçleri — Freelance

Istanbul, Turkey · June 2025 – Present

- Lead brand and visual direction for international kitchen-appliance and cosmetics lines — shaping identity, packaging, and e-commerce presentation across global markets.
- Art-direct prepress and production across Turkey–China supply chains, tightening visual consistency and reducing revision cycles.
- Direct the design of e-commerce platforms, from visual identity and conversion-focused UX through to back-end integration.

Creator & Art Director — Anatolian Futures: A Feminist Folklore (VR) | OCAD University

Toronto, ON, Canada · September 2024 – March 2025 · Defended April 2025

- Directed the full creative vision of an immersive VR experience in Unity — narrative, world-building, visual identity, and interaction design.
- Designed environments, 3D assets, and UI systems for a cohesive immersive aesthetic.
- Engineered interactive systems with AI-assisted C# scripting, balancing creative intent against technical performance and hardware constraints.
- Iterated the experience through user testing and feedback loops, from prototype to public technical defense.

Associate Product Designer | Passion Punch Studio

Istanbul, Turkey · April 2023 – July 2023

- Designed UI/UX and brand assets for a mobile gaming platform, aligning visual and product direction across Design, Product, and Engineering.
- Maintained visual and design-system consistency across features and brand rollouts within Agile sprints (Asana).
- Ran QA reviews to keep visual and technical execution cohesive across multidisciplinary teams.

Game Design Intern | Passion Punch Studio

Istanbul, Turkey · December 2022 – March 2023

- Reworked UI/UX and core gameplay flows for a match-3 title, smoothing friction to improve session quality and retention.
- Translated product goals into wireframes and design assets for clean hand-off to engineering.
- Benchmarked casual-game and monetization trends to inform design and feature direction.

Interior Design Intern | Toros & Partners

Istanbul, Turkey · September 2020 – December 2020

- Developed concepts for hospitality and residential projects alongside the design team, from visual moodboards through to material selection.
- Drew plans, elevations, and circulation models for industrial kitchens.
- Rendered interiors to communicate spatial and material intent.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Master of Design, Digital Futures | OCAD University, Toronto, ON | 2023 – 2025

Specialized in emerging technologies, immersive design, and human-centered innovation.

Bachelor of Arts in Design, Product Design | NABA, Milan, Italy | 2019 – 2022

Concentration in interior design.

Industrial Design | Pratt Institute, New York, NY | 2018 – 2019

Foundation year, before relocating to Milan.

Data Analyst Certification, DAC | BrainStation, Toronto, ON | 2024

SQL, Excel, and Python for data-driven decision making.

High School Diploma | American Robert College, Istanbul, Turkey

Graduated from Turkey's top high school, admitting students in the top 0.5% nationwide via a competitive entrance exam.